

Introduction to Biblical Greek

Session 3

Nouns, Adjectives, and the Definite Article in John 3:16

For God so loved the world that He
 θεός *theos* *ὁ* *kosmos*
 gave His only Son, so that everyone who believes
 μονογενής *monogenēs* υἱός *huios* πᾶς *pas*
 in Him may not perish but have eternal life.
 αἰώνιος *aiōnios* ζωή *zōē*

Definite articles in John 3:16

οὕτως γὰρ ἠγάπησεν ὁ θεὸς τὸν κόσμον
the (god) the (world)

ὥστε τὸν υἱὸν τὸν μονογενῆ ἔδωκεν
the (son) the (only)

ἵνα πᾶς ὁ πιστεύων εἰς αὐτὸν
the (believing)

μὴ ἀπόληται ἀλλ' ἔχη ζωὴν αἰώνιον

-ος

N

τον

A

C

θ

English Grammar 101

Personal Pronouns:

A substitute word used in place of a noun or noun phrase.

(he, she, it, they, etc)

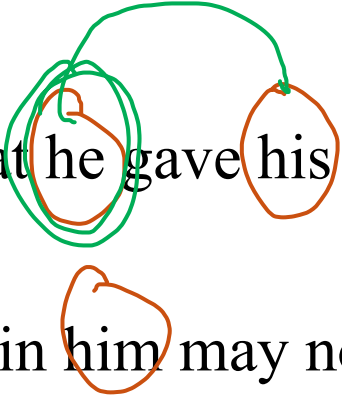
he
to him P/G
his /G

Singular
He
She
It

Plural
them
they

John 3:16 (NRSV) / Personal Pronouns

For God so loved the world that he gave his only Son,
so that everyone who believes in him may not perish
but may have eternal life.



John 3:16 (NRSV) / Personal Pronouns

οὕτως γὰρ ἠγάπησεν ὁ θεὸς τὸν κόσμον

ὥστε τὸν υἱὸν τὸν μονογενῆ ἔδωκεν

ἵνα πᾶς ὁ πιστεύων εἰς αὐτὸν

μὴ ἀπόληται ἀλλ' ἔχῃ ζωὴν αἰώνιον

he

αὐτός - N

all the believing

Person Pronouns

2nd

~~First~~ declension, masculine, third person.

N
A
G
O

Subject
Direct object
Indirect object
Possessive case

ο

Singular

οι

Plural

Nominative

αὐτὸς / he

αὐτοὶ / they

Accusative

αὐτὸν / him

αὐτούς / them

Dative

αὐτῷ / to him

αὐτοῖς / to them

Genitive

αὐτοῦ / his

αὐτῶν / their

Greek Nouns (recap)

1. Greek sentences *do not* require word order to make sense to the reader, unlike in English.
2. Noun cases solves the 'problem' of word order.
 - Why Greek words change a lot!
 - Why almost every Greek noun is preceded by the definite article.
3. Case endings reveal grammatical information.
 - Gender, number, and case.
4. All Greek nouns are either first, second, or declension.
third



10:05 pm

NA28
Nestle - Aland
UBS
United Bible Society
Tyndale

faith Jesus Christ
pistis Iēsou Christou

The πίστις Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ Debate

faith (in) Jesus Christ

Romans 3:22

(Similar constructions in Gal 2:16, Phil 3:9)

1) Simon's pen
2) the pen of Simon

faith of

What does your translation say?

(ESV, NIV, NRSV, NASB, KJV, NKJV, etc)

The πίστις Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ Debate

Romans 3:22

ESV: the righteousness of God through faith in Jesus Christ for all who believe.

NIV: This righteousness is given through faith in^[a] Jesus Christ to all who believe.

NRSV: the righteousness of God through faith ~~in~~ Jesus Christ^[a] for all who believe.

KJV: Even the righteousness of God which is by faith of Jesus Christ unto all and upon all them that believe.

The πίστις Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ Debate

Romans 3:22

δικαιοσύνη δὲ θεοῦ διὰ ^{Faith of Jesus Christ} πίστεως Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ

εἰς πάντα τοὺς πιστεύοντας

The πίστις Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ Debate

Is it the “faith in Jesus Christ”, or
the “faith of Jesus Christ”?

Or

the “faithfulness of Jesus Christ”?

Object genitive

Subject genitive

The πίστις Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ Debate

πίστις in the lexicon

- ① “someone in whom confidence can be placed;
faithfulness, reliability, fidelity, commitment”
BDAG, s.v. “πίστις”, C.f Gal 5:22.

① popular

②

③

The πίστις Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ Debate

“The question is one which cannot be settled on the basis of appeals to grammatical construction alone. This issue can be settled only by exegesis...”

Morna D. Hooker, ‘πιστις Χριστοῦ’, *New Testament Studies* 35 (1989), p. 321.

The πίστις Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ Debate

Subject

8 Indeed, I count everything as loss because of the surpassing worth of knowing Christ Jesus my Lord. For his sake I have suffered the loss of all things and count them as rubbish, in order that I may gain Christ 9 and be found in him, not having a righteousness of my own that comes from the law, but that which comes through *faith in Christ*, the righteousness from God that depends on faith— 10 that I may know him and the power of his resurrection, and may share his sufferings, becoming like him in his death, 11 that by any means possible I may attain the resurrection from the dead.

faithfulness
of
Christ

Philippians 3:8-10

of X
is X

The πίστις Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ Debate

/ object

16 yet we know that a person is not justified by works of the law but through *faith in Jesus Christ*, so we also have believed in Christ Jesus, in order to be justified by *faith in Christ* and not by works of the law, because by works of the law no one will be justified.

Galatians 2:16

The Genitive in Romans 5:5

“God’s love”

“5 and hope does not put us to shame, because *God’s love* has been poured into our hearts through the Holy Spirit who has been given to us.”

ESV

Subject
God's love
for us

ἡ ἀγάπη τοῦ Θεοῦ

Is it God's love for us, or our love for God?

S Object

Romans 5:5

“A man’s free-will, indeed, avails for nothing except to sin, if he knows not the way of truth; and even after his duty and his proper aim shall begin to become known to him, unless he also take delight in and feel a love for it, he neither does his duty, nor sets about it, nor lives rightly. Now, in order that such a course *may engage our affections, God’s love is shed abroad in our hearts*, not through the free-will which arises from ourselves, but *through the Holy Ghost*, which is given to us.”

Augustine on Romans 5:5